GG-M-571D
March 29, 1973
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. GG-M-00571C(GSA-FSS)
January 6, 1969, and
Fed. Spec. GG-M-571
July 26, 1951

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

MOISTENER, PAPER SEALING, FOUNTAIN-TYPE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers a fountain-type moistener.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple-Wall.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes: Paperboard, Metal Edged and Components.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

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National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. All material used in the fabrication of the fountain-type moistener shall be of good commerical quality suitable for the purpose intended.

3.1.1 Plastic. Plastic used shall be nonflammable, flame resistant, or slow burning when tested as specified in 4.4.5. The tube shall be fabricated from 0.025-inch ± 0.005 inch translucent or transparent plastic.

3.1.2 Metal. Metal parts, if used, shall be noncorrosive or shall be treated to resist corrosion, and shall meet the test requirements of 4.4.4.

3.1.3 Sponge. The sponge shall be of plastic; regenerated cellulose; or natural rubber, synthetic rubber, or a combination thereof.

3.1.4 Hard rubber composition. Hard rubber composition shall be made of natural rubber, synthetic rubber, or a combination thereof.

3.2 Design and construction. The moistener shall be of a fountain-type design so as to be easily held in the hand. It shall be designed to carry water in a tube and have a satisfactorily moistener surface on one end to rub on letter flaps or other glued surfaces to be sealed. Provisions shall be made so that when not in use the water will not drain from the tube. The moistener shall meet the tests specified in 4.4.

3.2.1 Water-container tube. The water-container tube shall be fabricated of plastic as specified in 3.1.1. The tube shall be closed on end end and open on the other end. The open end shall be sufficiently smooth to prevent injury to personnel. The cross section of the tube shall be either circular or elliptical. If circular, the minimum outside diameter shall be 1/2 inch. If elliptical, the major outside axis shall be 7/8 inch long, and the minor outside axis 1/2 inch long. A tolerance of plus or minus 1/32-inch is authorized for elliptical tubes.

3.2.2 Sponge. The sponge may be made from any materials specified in 3.1.3. The dimension of the sponge shall be as follows: The sponge shall project from the sponge housing at least 1/2 inch and shall provide a contact area of not less than 3/4 square inch when sponge is compressed not more than half the dimension of the projected sponge. The radius for cylindrical or circular sponge ends shall be at least 1/2 inch and the projected area shall be at least 3/4 square inch. The dimensions shall be so proportioned as to give a good moistening surface area. The void space shall be of proper size so as to give proper water absorption from the tube and large enough so as to provide sufficient flow of water during use.

3.2.3 Sponge housing. The sponge housing shall be molded from plastic or hard-rubber composition as specified in 3.1.1 and 3.1.4, and shall be of dimensions to properly contain the sponge. The sponge shall be attached permanently to the housing either by a tight fit or by a waterproof adhesive so it will not work loose while in use. Any metal clips or springs used in the attachment or in performing any other function shall be so positioned as not to interfere with the moistening of adhesive surfaces. Metal used shall be in accordance with 3.1.2.

3.3 Dimension. The over-all length of the completed moistener shall be 6 inches minimum and 8 inches maximum.

3.4 Identification marking. Each moistener shall be marked with the manufacturer's name or trade-mark.

3.5 Workmanship. The moistener shall be free from any defects and imperfections which affect the appearance or which might impair serviceability. All edges or surfaces shall be smooth and free from sharp or rough edges.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Lot. A lot shall consist of all moisteners offered for inspection at one time.

4.2.2 Sampling of end item for visual examination. A random sample of moisteners shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-4. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one moistener.

4.2.3 Sampling for preparation for delivery requirements. For examination of interior packages the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operation. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

4.2.4 Sampling for test. A random sample of moisteners shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-2. The AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective except as modified in 4.4.5. The sample unit shall be one moistener.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Visual examination of end item. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined for defects listed in table I. Any sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected. The Government reserves the right to classify as a defect any departure from the specification not listed in table I.

TABLE I. Classification of moistener defects

Examine	Defects
Material Tube	Not as specified. Not translucent or transparent.
Construction	Not constructed as specified.
Identification marking	Manufacturer's name or trade-mark missing.
Dimensions	Length not within tolerance.
Wall thickness	Not 0.025-inch thickness (± 0.005).
Tubes (circular)	Less than 1/2 inch diameter.
Tubes (elliptical)	Major outside axis not 7/8" (± 1/32"). Minor outside axis not 1/2" (± 1/32").
Sponge	Missing. Not permanently attached to housing. Metal clips interfere with use. Projects from housing less than 1/2". Radius of circular sponge ends less than 1/2". Contact area less than 3/4 square inch when sponge is compressed to 1/2 dimension of projection sponge.
Workmanship	Sharp or rough edges, fins, scratches, cracks, warped.

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4.3.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. Samples selected in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be examined to determine that the preservation, packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II.

TABLE II. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Material	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling, or distortion of container.
Contents	Number per container is more or less than required. Net weight exceeds requirements of the box specification.

4.4 Tests. One sample moistener taken in accordance with 4.2.4 shall be set aside for the burn test specified in 4.4.5. The remaining samples taken in accordance with 4.2.4 shall be filled with water to 90% of capacity and tested as specified in 4.4.1 through 4.4.4.

4.4.1 Performance test. All moisteners filled with water as specified in 4.4 shall be drawn across any smooth surface to activiate water flow to the sponge. One moistener shall be used to moisten the glue surface of ten 10-inch envelopes. Examine the envelopes for inadequate or excessive water which prevents sealing of the envelopes, and examine the moistener for leaking and metal interfering with the moistening operation.

4.4.2 Impact test. The sample moisteners specified in 4.4 shall be dropped five times from a height of 5 feet to a concrete or other hard surface floor. No parts shall fracture or loosen during test.

4.4.3 Leak test. The sample moisteners specified in 4.4 shall be hung in a vertical position with the sponge end down for 1 hour . No water shall seep out of the sponge or leak out of the tube.

4.4.4 Corrosion resistant test. Remove metal parts from one moistener previously tested in 4.4.3 and place them in a boiling water and sodium chloride (10% by weight) solution for fifteen minutes. Remove metal parts from this solution and immediately immerse them in a water and sodium chloride (10% by weight) solution for one hour at room temperature. They shall then be removed from this solution and, without having the adhering liquid wiped off, allowed to dry for 24 hours at room temperature and then wiped free of any residue and examine for presence of corrosion (3.1.2).

4.4.5 Burn test. The moistener specified in 4.4 shall be subjected to the following: A draft shield shall be used to reduce air current effects. Hold the specimen within the shield with the flame from a lighted safety match just touching one end of the specimen until the specimen ignites, or for a period of not over 10 seconds. Remove the flame. If the specimen will not support combustion, it is nonflammable. If the specimen burns when in contact with the flame but will not continue to burn when the flame is removed, it is flame resistant. If the specimen continues to burn with a slow steady flame, it is slow-burning. If the specimen bursts into flame immediately, or bursts into flame and continues to burn rapidly after the match is removed, it is to be considered as not meeting the requirements of this specification. One failure of the burn tests shall be cause for rejection of the entire lot. (3.1.1.)

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Twenty-four moisteners shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic, style optional, PPP-B-566, PPP-B-676 or PPP-B-665. Boxes shall be secured to prevent accidental opening during shipment and storage.

5.1.2 Level C. The moisteners shall be packaged to insure protection during shipment and safe delivery to destination.

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5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Moisteners packaged as specified in 5.1 and in the quantities specified (see 6.2), shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2, PPP-B-636 grade V3c minimum or PPP-B-640, class 2. The box shall be closed in accordance with the applicable specification or appendix thereto.

5.2.2 Level B. Fifty packages of moisteners packaged as specified in 5.1 (1200 moisteners) shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, grade 275 minimum. The box shall be closed in accordance with method II of the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. The moisteners packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed to comply with the Uniform Freight Classification rules or the National Motor Freight Classification rules as applicable.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, all marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2, as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. All marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. All marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The moistener covered by this specification is intended for moistening gummed tapes, labels, and envelope flaps prior to sealing, and for other similar uses.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(c) Whether civil or military marking is required (see 5.3).
(d) Number of moisteners per shipping container for level A (see 5.2.1).

DOD WAIVED COORDINATION

User Interest:

Army - GL

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 10 cents each.

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